

Paying for Education and Training



NAME _____

DATE _____

PERIOD _____

Method Guide

METHOD	WHAT IT DOES	KEY BOUNDARY
Scholarship	Gift aid from a school or other provider	Eligibility, deadlines, and conditions vary
Grant	Aid that generally does not require repayment when conditions are met	Eligibility and continued requirements vary
Work-study	Eligible student earns money through a job	Not an automatic tuition discount or guaranteed job
Loan	Borrowed money can cover eligible costs	Must be repaid with interest and complete terms matter
Savings/529	Money set aside before the bill	Rules, taxes, ownership, and available balance vary
Employer tuition benefit	Employer pays or reimburses some education cost	Job, eligible program, amount, timing, and stay requirements vary
Registered Apprenticeship	Paid job with structured learning and a portable credential	Current opening and sponsor terms vary

Two methods that reduce cost without creating repayment:

One method that earns money and one that borrows money:

FAFSA, TASFA, and Texas Policy

FAFSA is a free application used to determine eligibility for federal grants, work-study, and loans. States, schools, and some private providers also use FAFSA information. FAFSA is not an aid award or a loan by itself.

Current Texas public-school graduation policy requires a senior to do one of the following:

- 1. complete and submit FAFSA;
- 2. complete and submit TASFA; or
- 3. submit a signed opt-out form.

Middle-school students do none of these in this lesson. Never enter a Social Security number, tax data, family income, citizenship/immigration information, or personal aid account for class.

Explain the difference between an application and an aid offer:

Fictional Case 1 – Reduce the Price First

Taylor has a strong academic record and community-service experience. Taylor wants a current college or technical-school program but has not compared aid offers.

First two methods to investigate and why:

1.
-
2.
-

One deadline or condition to verify:

Why a loan should not be mislabeled as free money:

Fictional Case 2 — Earn While Learning

Jordan wants structured technical training and paid work. A current Registered Apprenticeship listing may fit, but there is no guaranteed opening.

What Jordan must verify in a real sponsor listing:

How this route changes the payment picture:

One reason a technical-college route could still be a better fit:

Fictional Case 3 — Build a Funding Sequence

Sam has a college/career-school goal and an employer that may offer tuition support after six months of employment.

Put four actions in a sensible order:

1.

2.

3.

4.

Name one method that reduces cost, one that earns money, and one that creates repayment:

One claim Sam must verify rather than assume:
